Indigestion

- Indigestion occurs when your stomach produces too much acid and it backs up into your oesophagus.
- Only weak bases are safe enough to use in antacids.
- Your stomach contains hydrochloric acid.
- Indigestion tablets called antacids contain a base.
- Stomach acid helps digest your food and kill bacteria.
- The antacid tablets neutralise the extra acid.
- Some antacid tablets contain the bases calcium carbonate and magnesium hydroxide.

☞ **1** Use the notes above to write a paragraph about indigestion in your workbook.

2 Sam and Alisha conducted an experiment to find out which was the most effective antacid. They added 5 drops of universal indicator to 20 mL of hydrochloric acid that was the same strength as stomach acid. They then added crushed antacid tablet one spatula at a time until the solution turned green. Their results are shown below.

Antacid tablet	Number of spatulas of antacid needed
A	5
B	7
C	8

a Why do you think they crushed the antacid tablets first? _____

_____

b What would the pH of the solution be when it turned green? _____

c Which was the most effective antacid? _____

d How could Sam and Alisha more accurately measure the amount of antacid being added? _____

_____

© Janine Haeusler and Blake Education 2014
ISBN 978 1 92571 062 5